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**Gov. Braun Awards Grant to Transform Rural Healthcare
in Northeast Indiana Region**

Indianapolis, IN- Gov. Mike Braun announced today that the northeast Indiana region (Region 2) has been awarded \$20.7 million in Growing Rural Opportunities for Well-Being (GROW) initiative grants. GROW region two includes Adams, Cass, Dekalb, Huntington, Kosciusko, LaGrange, Miami, Noble, Steuben, Wabash, Wells and Whitley counties.

GROW is focused on improving healthcare access, quality and outcomes in rural communities across the state of Indiana and supported by the Indiana Rural Health Transformation Program (RHTP), administered by the Indiana Department of Health (IDOH) and Family and Social Services Administration (FSSA). Indiana received nearly \$207 million for the first of the five-year federal Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) grant program. About \$120 million, or 60% of that funding, was earmarked for the regional grants.

"The Trump Administration's Rural Health Transformation Program is based on one simple idea: your access to quality health care shouldn't depend on your ZIP code," said CMS Administrator Dr. Mehmet Oz. "Funding new approaches to expand access and improve health outcomes for rural Hoosiers is an important step toward achieving that vision and I look forward to seeing RHTP dollars support equally transformative innovations for rural communities nationwide."

"This funding is a major step forward in our commitment to making health care affordable and accessible for all Hoosiers," Gov. Braun said. "It's an important stride toward creating a more sustainable and connected network in rural Indiana."

Region 2 GROW grant activities include:

- **Coordinate a regional care network:** Uses Project ECHO, RPM, Cardiometabolic Clinics, specialty referral pathways and community-based wellness programs to create greater access to care.

- **Reduce barriers to care:** Expand same day primary care access, mobile health units, mobile diagnostics, telehealth, navigation services and behavioral health crisis response to address transportation, provider shortages, and long travel times.
- **Improve healthcare workforce:** Strengthen clinical pipelines, expand rural training pathways, recruiting critical providers, implement telehealth-supported care models and integrate wraparound supports such as childcare and transportation for workforce stability.
- **Modernize and expand rural transportation systems;** Coordinate regional planning, upgrade technology, stabilize workforce, expand vehicle availability and improve cross-county collaboration to enhance access to healthcare, employment and social resources.
- **Establishing County and Regional Coalition Coordinators:** Unify hospitals, public health, EMS, behavioral health, transportation and community organizations under a common rural health strategy through shared implementation structures and cross-sector partnerships.

Rural Health Transformation Program's GROW will now move into implementation building on a foundation of strong collaboration, local leadership and meaningful impact from targeted activities.

Region 2's award complements the seven other regions that received GROW regional grants. RHTP also includes 11 statewide initiatives that promote workforce investment, thoughtful partnerships and infrastructure development. Additional information about the GROW regional grants and 11 statewide initiatives are available on the RHTP website growruralhealth.in.gov.

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